Categories	1	2	3	4	5
Appropriate AI use	Uses AI to complete substantial parts of the task without explaining or checking the output, or avoids AI without considering whether it could appropriately support the task.	Uses AI for some tasks but does not consistently explain why AI was chosen or independently review important outputs.	Uses AI for defined support tasks and checks important outputs before using them.	Chooses AI selectively for tasks where it adds value, verifies important outputs, and keeps major research decisions under human control.	Consistently selects or rejects AI based on task suitability, documents its role, verifies consequential outputs, and clearly explains how AI supported rather than replaced their work.
Research Self-Awarenes s	Does not identify relevant strengths, limitations, or knowledge gaps.	Identifies at least one limitation or gap but gives little explanation of how it affects the research task.	Identifies multiple strengths or gaps and suggests at least one reasonable improvement step.	Accurately connects strengths and limitations to the research task and proposes specific actions to address gaps.	Accurately evaluates strengths and limitations, prioritizes the most important gaps, and creates a realistic plan with specific next steps for improvement.
Research Process Skills	Has difficulty identifying a research question, locating relevant sources, organizing evidence, or selecting an appropriate method. .	Completes basic research tasks with substantial guidance, such as finding sources or organizing information.	Independently completes common research tasks such as locating, reading, organizing, and summarizing relevant sources or data.	Selects and applies an appropriate research method and connects evidence to the research question.	Compares possible methods or evidence, justifies the selected approach, identifies limitations, and adapts the research strategy when needed.
Responsible AI & ethics	Does not identify clear ethical risks involving AI, privacy, bias, attribution, or research participants.	Identifies an ethical concern when it is obvious but does not explain an appropriate response.	Identifies common ethical risks and proposes an action consistent with relevant research or AI-use expectations.	Anticipates multiple ethical risks before acting and explains steps to reduce risks involving privacy, attribution, bias, or participant data.	Evaluates competing ethical considerations, justifies a responsible course of action, and explains safeguards for complex or uncertain

					situations.
Academic Integrity	Uses or proposes using AI-generated or outside material without attribution, or presents assisted work as entirely original.	Recognizes that disclosure or attribution may be required but applies it inconsistently or incompletely.	Correctly attributes outside or AI-assisted material and follows stated course or institutional expectations.	Clearly documents how AI or other assistance was used and distinguishes assisted work from the student's own intellectual contribution.	Consistently applies appropriate attribution and disclosure across different research tasks and can explain why the chosen practice preserves authorship and academic integrity.
Critical Thinking & Verification	Accepts a claim or AI output without questioning, checking evidence, or attempting verification.	Notices that information may be questionable but provides little reasoning or no clear verification method.	Questions the information, considers evidence, and proposes at least one reasonable verification step.	Checks credibility using relevant evidence or sources, recognizes uncertainty, and explains why a particular conclusion or action is justified.	Compares multiple explanations or sources, verifies key claims using reliable evidence, identifies limitations or conflicts, and justifies a well-supported conclusion.
Independent Reasoning	Relies on AI to generate conclusions, interpretations, or decisions without providing their own reasoning.	Provides some independent reasoning but usually follows the AI recommendation without meaningful comparison.	Uses AI as support while making the final decision using their own stated reasoning.	Explicitly compares AI suggestions with their own reasoning and available evidence before deciding.	Uses AI as a cognitive aid while producing an independently justified conclusion that could stand on its own without the AI recommendation.

Important Note: *Scores are assigned only from observable evidence in the student's response or demonstrated behavior. Self-reported confidence alone is not sufficient evidence for a higher score. If a scenario does not provide enough evidence to assess a category, the category should be marked "Insufficient Evidence" rather than assigned a score.*